

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-08

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 21:1-8

1 Now Satan stood up against Israel, and moved David to number Israel.

2 So David said to Joab and to the leaders of the people, "Go, number Israel from Beersheba to Dan, and bring the number of them to me that I may know it."

3 And Joab answered, "May the Lord make His people a hundred times more than they are. But, my lord the king, are they not all my lord's servants? Why then does my lord require this thing? Why should he be a cause of guilt in Israel?"

4 Nevertheless the king's word prevailed against Joab. Therefore Joab departed and went throughout all Israel and came to Jerusalem.

5 Then Joab gave the sum of the number of the people to David. All Israel had one million one hundred thousand men who drew the sword, and Judah had four hundred and seventy thousand men who drew the sword.

6 But he did not count Levi and Benjamin among them, for the king's word was abominable to Joab.

7 And God was displeased with this thing; therefore He struck Israel.

8 So David said to God, "I have sinned greatly, because I have done this thing; but now, I pray, take away the iniquity of Your servant, for I have done very foolishly."

II. Key Summary

- Satan stood up against Israel and moved David, who ordered Joab and the leaders to count Israel from Beersheba to Dan so he could know their number.

- Joab objected and asked why the king would bring guilt on Israel, but the king's word won out; Joab reported 1,100,000 swordsmen in Israel and 470,000 in Judah, leaving Levi and Benjamin uncounted.

- God was displeased and struck Israel; David prayed, admitting he had sinned greatly

and acted very foolishly, and asked God to take away his guilt.

III. Passage Analysis

Counting Until You Forget God

David's numbering of the people brought great disaster... this census came from David's desire to show off his military strength. Once he wanted a firm grip on his own military power, he had already started to rely on his army more than on God. [1]

Counting people isn't automatically wrong; the problem was why David did it. After many victories, he started finding his security in "how many soldiers I have" instead of in the God who had given him every win.

When You Fall, Turn Back Fast

The man after God's heart was not sinless, but he had a heart sensitive to sin when he did commit it. David kept a short account with God. [2]

David didn't make excuses or blame Satan or Joab. He simply said, "I have sinned greatly" and "I have done very foolishly." Belonging to God doesn't mean never messing up; it means owning it quickly when you do.

IV. Reflection Question

What number do you count most to measure yourself—grades, followers, likes, or how much money you've saved? The last time you went out of your way to check it, what had just happened?

David counted over a million men with swords, then admitted to God he had "done very foolishly," because Israel's strength never came from its numbers—it came from God.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), 1 Chronicles 21 Study

Notes (citing the Devotional Bible Commentary),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT21.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, 1 Chronicles 21 Commentary,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-21/>